

Nokia netbooks soon

Nokia, the leader in mobile phones, is considering to bridge the gap between mobiles and PCs, by joining the netbook market

Goal

Electronic Arts and U.S. Soccer have together formed a new plan to give free online virtual training to budding soccer enthusiasts

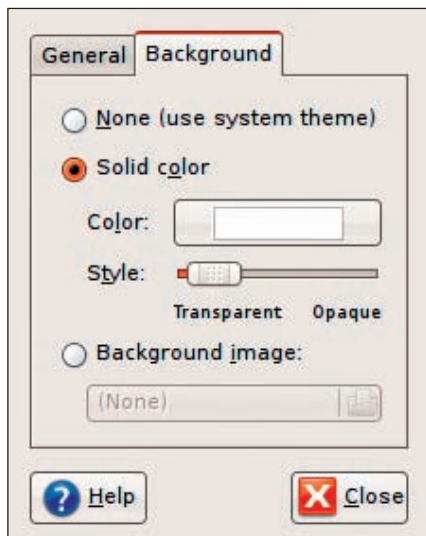
Workshop

```
separator=0
GtkTreeView::horizontal-
separator=0
GtkTreeView::expander-size=4
GtkTreeView::fixed-height-
mode=TRUE
GtkWidget::focus_padding=0
}
class "GtkWidget" style
"gtkcompact"

style "gtkcompactextra" {
xthickness=0
ythickness=0
}
class "GtkButton" style
"gtkcompactextra"
class "GtkToolbar" style
"gtkcompactextra"
class "GtkPaned" style
"gtkcompactextra"
```

The first thing we changed here is the font, well the font is the same, but we have reduced the font size to 8 instead of the default 10. You could also try Bitstream Vera Sans Roman 8 to see if you prefer that font.

We have reduced the sizes of the boxes and borders to it's bare minimal with the settings provided. The button borders, internal and external have been pulled down. To change these values you can



Adjust the panel setting with the Panel Properties

mess with the values which correspond to the four sides of the button.

```
GtkButton::default_
border={0,0,0,0}
GtkButton::default_outside_
border={0,0,0,0}
```

To change the spaces between alphabets and numbers you can adjust the value in the following line, 0 being the minimum we have selected:

```
GtkScale::value_spacing=0
```

With GNOME, the buttons don't contain labels, they have what is called a child menu, which mostly is a label or could even be an image or a pixmap. We have kept the dimensions of the child widget to a minimum for netbooks, but you can change them by adjust the values in the lines:

```
GtkButtonBox::child_min_
width=0
GtkButtonBox::child_min_
height=0
GtkButtonBox::child_
internal_pad_x=0
GtkButtonBox::child_
internal_pad_y=0
```

Similarly, the height and width of all the menus, menubars, scrollbars and toolbars have been kept to a minimum value. The GtkExpander option is connected to the GtkTreeView which is the list navigation style in GNOME.

We'd advise you to use the TreeView with your netbook, which is basically list view, so it's easier to navigate between files. You can optimise the size of the list format by adjusting the TreeView values.

```
GtkTreeView::vertical-
separator=0
GtkTreeView::horizontal-
separator=0
```

After these changes there are a few more things you can change to optimize GNOME further for your netbook.

A single panel is all that's needed

By default Ubuntu comes with two panels located at the top and bottom of the screen. You don't really want this as it takes up too much desktop space. So start off by right-clicking the lower panel and click on **Delete This Panel**. Don't get too afraid as you won't really lose anything by deleting the panel. The folders or items that were present on that panel can be easily added to the other panel by just right-clicking on that panel and selecting the option **Add To Panel**.

Now you are left with a single top panel. Let's tweak this a bit more, right-click the top panel and go to **Properties**. Here you should reduce the size of the Panel to the least possible number so as to increase the vertical space on the desktop.

Next thing to do is change the orientation of this panel to the right or left, which ever you prefer. And to add a bit of style factor we have changed the opacity of the panel as well. To do that, go to Panel Properties by right-clicking on the panel and selecting properties. To change the orientation, select the



No need to cluster the panel with windows

location from the drop-down menu. This is optional as some of you might prefer a top or bottom orientation.

To change the opacity, navigate to the Background tab and select **Solid color**. Change the opacity by using the slider.

You can also uncheck the Expand option in the Properties window, which will give the panel a smaller size that may not take up the entire height of the screen.

Looks aren't everything

If you don't mind simplistic looks, then you can also directly just disable the icons that are displayed in the menu bar. For this you need to go to **System > Preferences > Appearance**, navigate to the Interface tab and uncheck the option **Show icons in menus**. You will instantly see a reduction in the size of icons on the panel and if you open any menus from the menu bar you will also notice that you don't have any icons left.

Another little thing you could change is the text below the icons. By default, all the programs in Ubuntu have text below icons. If you disable the text and keep only the icons it would free a bit more of vertical space. To do this, revisit the Interface tab of Appearance settings. Here, select **Icons only** from the drop down options under the **Toolbar buttons label** option. Again nothing to get too worried about, most of the icons are self explanatory and if you do come across something that you don't understand then you can always just mouse over for the tooltip.

Stack up those windows

The last thing that we will be discussing here is to reduce the clutter created by open programs on the Panel. We will be using the tool Windows Selector for this task and it's very easy to implement. All you have to do is right-click on the Panel and select **Add To Panel**. Next type in 'Windows Selector' in the search field and click on Add. Once it's done all your windows will be stacked into a single button on the Panel. 